

3 (a) (i) Gravitational potential at a point is defined as **work done per unit mass** by an external agent to **move a test mass from infinity to that point** in the gravitational field (without a change in kinetic energy)

(ii) Gravitational potential at **infinity is defined as zero** and since gravitational force is attractive,

work done by external agent to move an object from infinity to a point in the gravitational field is **negative**, so potential is negative

(b) The **gradient of the potential–displacement** graph gives the gravitational **field strength, which is a vector**, thus, **the sign indicates the direction** of the gravitational field strength

Near the earth, the net gravitational field strength is directed towards the earth due to its larger influence than the moon while **near the moon, the net gravitational field strength is directed towards the moon** due to its larger influence. Hence, **their sign are opposite**

(c) (i) 1. Since the gravitational force the planet exert on moon A and B provides the centripetal force for them to rotate about the planet,

$$\frac{GM_p M_A}{r_A^2} = \frac{M_A v_A^2}{r_A} \text{ (together with statement for B1)}$$

$$\frac{GM_p}{r_A} = \frac{v_A^2}{1}$$

Since GM_p are constant, $v_A^2 \propto 1/r$,

$$\begin{aligned} v_A / v_B &= (r_B / r_A)^{1/2} \\ &= (2.2 \times 10^{10} / 1.3 \times 10^8)^{1/2} \\ &= 13 \text{ (13.0)} \end{aligned}$$

Fractions not accepted

$$2. v = 2\pi r / T$$

$$v \propto r / T$$

$$\begin{aligned} T_A / T_B &= (r_A / r_B) \times (v_B / v_A) \\ &= (1.3 \times 10^8 / 2.2 \times 10^{10}) \times (1 / 13) \\ &= 4.5 \text{ (4.54)} \times 10^{-4} \end{aligned}$$

$$\text{(ii)} \quad T = 2\pi / 1.7 \times 10^{-4} = 3.70 \times 10^4 \text{ s}$$

$$\begin{aligned} T_B &= 3.70 \times 10^4 / 4.54 \times 10^{-4} \\ &= 8.1 \times 10^7 \text{ s} \end{aligned}$$

